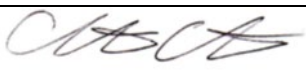


High Flow Nasal Cannula

Guideline Title: High Flow Nasal Cannula

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-PR032

Issue date: 7/17/2022	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates:	Developed by: Nina Hilton, Chief Flight Nurse
Approved by: Christopher Hunter, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by: Ty Campbell
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

- I. **PURPOSE:** This department guideline is for the purpose of high flow nasal cannula (HFNC) oxygen therapy delivering more precise and variant oxygen concentration to patients (> 6 LPM for adult or 2 LPM for neonates). HFNC provides a small amount of positive pressure and safely delivers higher oxygen concentration in a less invasive manner. Long term (> 60 minutes) usage of HFNC requires humidified oxygen, but shorter flights can utilize the technique without the extra step.
- II. **DEFINITIONS:**
 - d. HFNC – High Flow Nasal Cannula
 - e. Neonates: Patients < 15 kg
- III. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**
 - a. **EQUIPMENT:**
 - i. HFNC - a two-pronged device intended for direct flow administration of oxygen via the nasopharyngeal route.
 - b. **INDICATIONS:**
 - i. Hypoxemia or need for moderate ventilatory support
 - c. **CONTRAINDICATIONS:**
 - i. Inability to tolerate the cannula
 - ii. Severe respiratory depression or hypoxemia
 - iii. Significantly altered mental status (GCS < 8)
 - d. **INSTRUCTIONS FOR USE:**
 - i. Connecting to the ventilator:
 1. Connect the nasal cannula to the appropriate inspiratory and expiratory ports on the ventilator or breathing circuit.
 - ii. Fastening the nasal cannula:
 1. Put on a neck lanyard and nasal cannula.
 2. Adjust the tightness of the nasal cannula.
 3. Connect the nasal tube and breathing circuit.

iii. Securing the tubes:

1. Make sure the flow sensor measurement tubes are securely connected to the breathing circuit

f. **No humidification needed for flight times < 60 minutes**, anything greater than 60 minutes needs to be re-evaluated at bedside

g. Technical data

i. Oxygen concentration: 21% to 100%

1. 282495 Size S, Adult/pediatric cannula (4 mm) max flow 60 l/min
2. 282496 Size M, Adult cannula (5 mm) max flow 80 l/min
3. 282497 Size L, Adult cannula (6mm) max flow 80 l/min
4. Instructional Use Link [Nasal Cannula IFU \(hamilton-medical.com\)](https://www.hamilton-medical.com/dam/jcr:514187e1-b79a-4708-a4b8-e6d610699c85/Nasal-cannula-single-use-adult-pediatric-instructions-for-use-en-de-fr-es-it-pt-zh-ja-ru-tr.pdf)

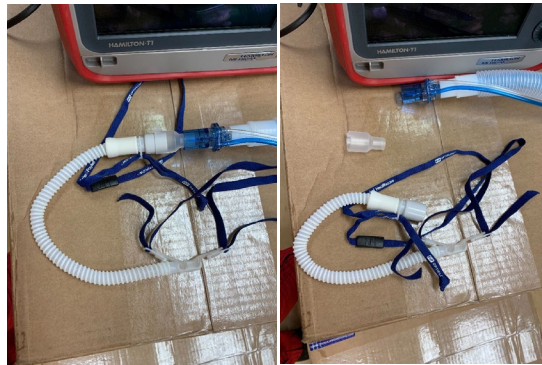
LXXVIII. **DOCUMENTATION:**

- a. EMSCharts

LXXIX. **REFERENCES:**

- b. Hamilton Nasal cannula Single-use nasal cannula, adult/pediatric
<https://www.hamilton-medical.com/dam/jcr:514187e1-b79a-4708-a4b8-e6d610699c85/Nasal-cannula-single-use-adult-pediatric-instructions-for-use-en-de-fr-es-it-pt-zh-ja-ru-tr.pdf>

Without the Omni-Flex Connector:



With the Omni-Flex Connector:

